

Tolina Yussuf

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Education

Kennesaw State University

Kennesaw, GA | May 2027

Bachelor of Science in Interactive Design, Minor in Information Systems

GPA: 3.86/4.0

Coursework: Productivity, Tools & Tech, Information Architecture, User Interface I, Interaction Design II, Information Systems & Communication, Application Development I, Prototyping II, Web Development I

Certifications: CITI Certification in Human Research, GWC & Accenture: Product Strategy for Product Managers

Skills

Design: User Experience Design, Lean UX, Agile Methodology, User Research, A/B Testing & Iteration, Data-Informed Decision Making, Prompt-Engineering, Web Development, Data-Informed Decision Making,

Languages: Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, HTML/CSS

Tools: Git/GitHub, React, Figma, Miro, Adobe Creative Suite, Microsoft 365, Google Search Console, Adobe XD

Experience

Founder & Product Lead | Afaan Arcade – Afaan Oromo Learning Platform

Atlanta, GA | Jul 2025 – Present

- Led customer discovery from 0 → 1 with Oromo diaspora students to define curriculum requirements by fluency level
- Scoped gamified learning modules in Figma, prioritizing features that drove language retention

UX/UI Designer & Team Lead | Blueprint – Mobile Style Platform

Kennesaw, GA | Feb 2026 – May 2026

- Owned product roadmap and backlog prioritization across 3 sprints for a 5-person cross-functional team
- Conducted 15 customer interviews across three sprints to prioritize MVP feature development.

Website & Social Media Audit Intern | The Lighthouse: Black Girl Projects

Jackson, MS | Jul 2026 – Present

- Ran cross-platform UX audit, converting qualitative and quantitative data into a prioritized backlog
- Synthesized Search Console and analytics data into a prioritized report for executive leadership

Social Media & Marketing Student Assistant | Kennesaw State University

Kennesaw, GA | Oct 2025 – Present

- Built and shipped a biweekly newsletter to 52,000+ students, sustaining a 19% open rate
- Scoped and produced career content aligned to the department's marketing calendar and engagement goals

Leadership & Professional Development

Management Leadership for Tomorrow | Career Prep Fellow

Feb 2025 - Present

- Selected for an 18-month fellowship developing leadership and technical skills for high-achieving diverse talent
- Completing technical interview prep and case-based assignments to build product and analytical acumen

Kamala Scholars Program | Grace Hopper Conference '25

Nov 2025 – Present

- Selected as 1 of 100 scholars nationally for a full scholarship to attend GHC, the largest gathering of women technologists globally
- Awarded a year-long mentorship and AnitaB.org membership to support continued growth in tech leadership

Women in Technology – KSU | Public Relations Officer

Apr 2025 – Oct 2025

- Owned content strategy and roadmap for WIT–KSU's LinkedIn presence, driving a 218.2% increase in weekly visitors
- Built recruiter partnerships and curated job opportunities for members, sustaining a 9.1% engagement rate

Kennesaw Excellence Society | Inaugural Member

Dec 2024 – Jun 2025

- Selected as 1 of 12 leaders from 125+ applicants for a rigorous, multi-stage inaugural ambassador program
- Served as strategic liaison between student body and administration, surfacing and prioritizing campus needs

Additional Organizations & Extracurriculars

UX/UI Club - KSU | Vice President

Kennesaw, GA | Jul 2026 – Present

- Building partnerships with campus and industry stakeholders to expand member opportunities and visibility
- Mentoring club members on design skills and career development, representing the club across campus initiatives

Advocates for Youth | Youth Organizer

Washington, D.C. | Sep 2024 – Present

- Developed a Know Your Rights resource in Afaan Oromo, expanding legal literacy access for the East African community
- Served on the Youth Activist Institute's Advisory Board, shaping thematic strategy and inclusion priorities

Women Empowering Nations | GLOW Global Cohort Fellow

Tulsa, OK | Sep 2024 – Present

- Selected as 1 of 75 leaders from 1,432 applicants across 120 countries for a global leadership cohort
- Engaged in biweekly workshops on personal growth, advocacy, and cross-cultural collaboration

Additional Organizations: ColorStack, NSBE, Rewriting the Code, Black Girls Code, Reboot Representation, AnitaB.org

Honors & Awards

Awards/Honors: KSU Journey Honors College, GHC '25 Kamala Scholar, AFROTECH x Duolingo Scholar, Dean's List, President's List